The 23 helping verbs

Name: _____ Date: _____

Read the chart. Then, in each sentence, circle the helping verb and underline the main verb it is helping.

THE 23 HELPING VERBS

Forms of BE:	am, is, are, was, were, be, being, been
Forms of HAVE:	have, has, had
Forms of DO:	do, does, did
Modals:	can, could, will, would, shall, should, may, might, must

A helping verb comes before the main verb and changes its time or meaning: "She IS reading", "They HAVE finished", "We WILL go".

FIND THE HELPING VERB AND THE MAIN VERB

1. The children are building a sandcastle.
2. My cousin has visited Canada twice.
3. We will plant sunflowers in April.
4. Dad was cooking dinner when the phone rang.
5. You should wear a helmet on your bike.
6. The kittens were sleeping in a basket.
7. I can swim across the whole pool.
8. They had eaten breakfast before school.
9. Does your brother play the drums?
10. It might rain during the picnic.
11. Grandma is knitting a scarf for me.
12. We must finish the project by Friday.

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The 23 helping verbs - Answer key



Helping verb / main verb for each sentence:

1. are / building
2. has / visited
3. will / plant
4. was / cooking
5. should / wear
6. were / sleeping
7. can / swim
8. had / eaten
9. does / play
10. might / rain
11. is / knitting
12. must / finish

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